MODULE 01 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

The Claude Associate

What CCAO-F tests, how the paper is built, and the map of Claude you will use for every question.

EXAM CCAO-F DOMAINS All seven MODULE 1 of 33

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This exam does not ask whether you can build with Claude. It asks whether you can **work well** with it.

Who the exam is for

- **People who use Claude for real work** – operations, marketing, project management, HR, education, communications.
- **Consultants and internal staff** who help others adopt Claude and redesign how work gets done.
- **Limited to moderate technical depth.** Beyond casual prompting, short of building systems.
- **Not developers** building on the API or designing agents. They have their own credentials.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> The guide's phrase for the target candidate: completes business tasks with Claude "with minimal guidance".

The exam in numbers

- **60 items in 120 minutes.** Two minutes each, reading included.
- **Multiple choice and multiple response.** Every item states how many answers to pick.
- **Scaled score from 100 to 1,000. Pass at 720.** Not a raw percentage.
- **Pearson VUE**, online proctored or at a test centre. USD 99.
- **Valid for 12 months.** Renew with a free, unproctored assessment.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Eligibility: you must work at a Claude Partner Network organisation. Check the current rules before booking.

Seven domains, weighted

DOMAIN	WEIGHT	THE QUESTION IT ASKS
D1 Prompting	14%	Can you ask well?
D2 Evaluation	21%	Can you judge the output?
D3 Selection	12%	Right feature, right model?
D4 Workflow	16%	Does it fit real work?
D5 Configuration	12%	Is the Project set up well?
D6 Governance	15%	Should we do this at all?
D7 Troubleshooting	10%	Can you fix a poor result?

ON THE EXAM

Weights are approximate shares of the 60 items. Your domain scores are reported, but only the total decides a pass.

The biggest domain is not prompting. It is **judging what comes back**.

The map of Claude

Everything the guide names, in one picture

Research
Many searches, cited
Minutes, not seconds

Projects
Instructions + knowledge
Shared with a team

Skills
Packaged procedures
Loaded when relevant

Memory
Context across chats
Edit, pause or reset

Chat
Web, desktop and mobile
Files and images in
Searches the web when useful
Where every task starts

Artifacts
Docs, slides, designs
Kept and shared

Code execution
Runs real code
Exact sums, real files

Models
Haiku, Sonnet, Opus
Speed versus depth

Connectors
Drive, Gmail, Calendar
Live company data

ON THE EXAM

Almost every selection and configuration question is about one of these boxes.

If Claude were an office

FEATURE	IN THE OFFICE, IT IS
Chat	A phone call with a bright colleague
Project	The project room: whiteboard, files, team
Memory	A colleague who remembers how you work
Research	An afternoon in the library, with references
Artifact	The finished document you hand over
Code execution	The calculator, not mental arithmetic
Skill	The laminated procedure card on the wall
Connector	A keycard to another building

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Match the need to the room. That settles most feature questions.

Three models, three jobs

MODEL	THINK OF IT AS	REACH FOR IT WHEN
Haiku	A moped	Speed and volume matter most
Sonnet	An estate car	Everyday work: the default
Opus	A removal lorry	The task is complex and hard

THE TIEBREAKER

The lorry can do the moped's job. Slowly, and at lorry prices.

The guide is from July. Claude has moved since.

- **Exam guide v1.0** took effect in July 2026. It names chat, Projects, research mode and Artifacts.
- **16 Sep 2026:** chat and Cowork merged into one Claude app, rolling out plan by plan.
- **Sep to Oct 2026:** Haiku, Sonnet and Opus 5.5 arrived. Fable 5.1 sits above Opus.
- **This course's rule:** answer by what a feature is for, not where its button is.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Exam items test tiers and purposes, not version numbers or menu paths. Module 29 covers every change.

Yours to do, or to hand on?

THE ASSOCIATE'S JOB

Use Claude's features well

- Prompt, check and refine outputs
- Choose features and models
- Set up Projects and connectors
- Spot risk and follow policy

ESCALATE TO ARCHITECTS AND DEVELOPERS

Build things on Claude

- Apps built on the API
- Agents that run unattended
- Integrations with other systems
- Enterprise AI architecture

THE TIEBREAKER

If it needs code, an API key or a system integration, your job is the requirement, not the build.

How the questions are shaped

- **One best answer from four.** About three items in four.
- **Choose two from five.** About one item in four. The item says so.
- **Sequence items:** put five steps in order, or pick the step that comes first or before. Nearly a quarter.
- **Scenario stems:** a role, a task, a constraint, then the ask.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Shares come from this course's analysis of a 119-item practice bank, not from Anthropic.

The shape most process questions follow

01
Frame
Purpose, audience, criteria.

02
Prepare
Gather and clean the inputs.

03
Do
Prompt, draft or run.

04
Check
Against criteria and sources.

05
Decide
Use, iterate or escalate.

06
Record
What was decided, and why.

ON THE EXAM

Framing comes first. Recording the decision comes last. Module 27 sharpens the exceptions.

Meet Halden Facilities Group

- **Facilities services** - cleaning, maintenance, security. Head office in Leeds.
- **3,400 staff**: 2,900 on client sites, 500 in offices. **260 client contracts.**
- **Claude Team plan**, 180 seats, with Google Workspace connected.
- **An AI policy** with four data classes: Public, Internal, Confidential, Restricted.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Fictional, and deliberately ordinary. Its problems are the exam's problems.

What Halden's teams want from Claude

- **Bids:** answer 200-page tenders faster, without missing a requirement.
- **Operations:** a clear weekly service report across 260 sites.
- **Customer success:** better apology emails after a missed visit.
- **HR:** keep up with about 900 new field recruits a year.
- **The chief operating officer:** "Claude writes client emails now, so we can stop checking them."

> COMING UP
>
> Four sensible ambitions and one trap. Module 9 settles the trap.

How to use this course

- **Pause at every scenario** and commit to an answer before the walkthrough.
- **Study the wrong answers.** Why they fail is what transfers to new questions.
- **Watch in order.** Later modules use earlier vocabulary.
- **Sit the three practice papers last**, timed, and score them by domain.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Watching a walkthrough without answering first feels like learning. Mostly, it is not.

> Halden's twelve bid writers reuse the same material in almost every tender: standard method statements, the pricing approach and three past winning bids.
>
> Each writer pastes the files into every new chat, and the versions they paste do not always match.

What should the bids team set up?

A Turn on Memory so Claude remembers the files for each writer

B Agree to paste the latest files at the start of every chat

C A shared Project holding the files, with instructions for the team

D An artifact containing the files, shared with each writer

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the bids team set up?

A. Turn on Memory so Claude remembers the files for each writer

Memory holds context about a person's work, not a controlled team library.

B. Agree to paste the latest files at the start of every chat

That is today's problem: repeated effort and mismatched versions.

C. A shared Project holding the files, with instructions for the team

One current set of files and rules, used in every chat in the Project.

D. An artifact containing the files, shared with each writer

An artifact is something Claude makes for you. It is not a knowledge base.

THE SIGNAL

Twelve people, many chats, the same reference files: a shared Project.

> Halden's operations director wants every client email in the shared maintenance inbox read overnight, classified, answered automatically and logged as a job in the scheduling system.
>
> Nobody would review the replies before they are sent.

What is the associate's best response?

A. Write up the business need and hand the build to IT and the Claude partner

B. Build it with a Project and the Gmail connector, running each night

C. Create a Skill that sends the replies and logs the jobs automatically

D. Tell the director that Claude cannot help with email at all

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the associate's best response?

A Write up the business need and hand the build to IT and the Claude partner

Unattended automation and system integration is Architect and Developer work.

B Build it with a Project and the Gmail connector, running each night

The Gmail connector reads and drafts; a person sends. A Project is not a scheduler.

C Create a Skill that sends the replies and logs the jobs automatically

A Skill packages a procedure inside a chat. It is not an unattended integration.

D Tell the director that Claude cannot help with email at all

Too absolute. Claude can draft and sort email with a person in the loop.

THE SIGNAL

Overnight, unattended, linked to another system: not an app-user build.

> Customer success receives several hundred routine emails a day asking when the next cleaning visit is. Each reply is short and follows a pattern, and an adviser checks every draft before it is sent.
>
> The team wants drafts back almost instantly, and the shared usage allowance is already tight.

Which model fits best?

A Opus, because client emails deserve the most capable model

B Opus with the highest effort setting, to avoid any mistakes

C Whichever model is newest, since newer is always better

D Haiku, the fastest model and the lightest on usage limits

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which model fits best?

A Opus, because client emails deserve the most capable model

Capable, but slower and heavier on limits than a simple pattern needs.

B Opus with the highest effort setting, to avoid any mistakes

Slower and heavier still. The adviser's check already guards quality.

C Whichever model is newest, since newer is always better

Newness is not a selection criterion. Fit to the task is.

D Haiku, the fastest model and the lightest on usage limits

High volume, simple pattern, speed matters, limits are tight.

THE SIGNAL

Routine, high volume, needs speed, allowance is tight: the light model.

> A Halden bid manager must brief the board on how public-sector buyers are changing cleaning contracts. She needs a cited overview drawing on many recent sources, and is happy to wait several minutes.
>
> She has no files of her own on the topic.

Which feature should she use?

A. A normal chat, asking Claude to answer from what it already knows

B. Research mode, which runs many searches and cites its sources

C. A new Project, with her past bid files added as knowledge

D. Code execution, to analyse the sources numerically

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which feature should she use?

A. A normal chat, asking Claude to answer from what it already knows

Training knowledge has a cutoff, and a board brief needs citations.

B. Research mode, which runs many searches and cites its sources

Many recent sources, cited, and she has time to wait.

C. A new Project, with her past bid files added as knowledge

A Project holds material you supply. Old bids say little about new trends.

D. Code execution, to analyse the sources numerically

The job is reading and synthesising, not calculating.

THE SIGNAL

Many sources, recent, cited, and minutes are fine: research mode.

In five lines

- CCAO-F tests **working well with Claude**, not building on it.
- **60 items, 120 minutes, 720 to pass.** Always read how many answers an item wants.
- **Evaluation is the biggest domain.** Judgement outweighs prompting.
- **Know the map:** chat, Projects, Memory, Research, Artifacts, Skills, Code execution, Connectors, three tiers.
- **Builds, integrations and unattended agents** go to Architects and Developers.

> COMING UP
>
> Next: the 4D framework, Anthropic's own language for using AI well.